Kaarthikeyan arrived from Hyderabad around 10 a.m. and went into a closed-door meeting with the commissioner of police, Bangalore.[9]



Ranganath came to know about Mridula's police detention from his brother-in-law. He did not know where she was. Also, he suspected police presence around where she was being kept. Going there would not be safe. He had spent the night at a local lodge. In the morning he had gone back to Konanakunte. Even as he was getting off the autorickshaw, the milk-delivery woman had recognized him as the man who had taken the house on rent. Ranganath had tried to run away. The crowd that had gathered to watch the drama caught him and handed him over to the police. Verma and Ragothaman were frustrated and angry at this bungling by the local police. It had to be a quiet operation, but the hideout was swarming with police in uniform, thereby alerting Sivarasan about the operation. But they held in their anger, knowing that any outburst at that stage would only add fuel to the fire.

Vijay Karan finally arrived, along with a cyanide expert, Dr Ramachari, around 4 p.m. The doctor immediately suggested that the SIT collect another set of cyanide antidote kits from Gwalior as the existing ones had reached their expiry date. Arrangements were made to do so, even though it would delay the raid by many more hours. Ravindran refused to agree with the doctor. He asserted that the antidotes remained effective until about fourteen days after the official date of expiry. Any further delay would take away from them even the iota of chance they had to catch Sivarasan alive. He got into an argument with the doctor but was stopped by Karan, who made it clear that the NSG had to wait until the fresh stocks arrived. Ravindran could not understand the need for these fresh stocks if the CBI director was so convinced that they would not catch Sivarasan alive. Verma joined in and asked Karan if the NSG could try their 'thirty-second' storming plan. But the bosses remained staunch on their decision. Strangely,